

Breakups

Different relationships end for different reasons. It's natural to look for someone or something to blame—but sometimes, things just don't work out. For both the person doing the breaking up and the person being broken up with, ending a relationship is difficult.

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Why relationships end

The end of a romantic or sexual relationship does not mean that it was a failed relationship. Sometimes, people change and grow apart. At other times, a relationship turns bad, and ending it is the best thing to do. There are times when ending a relationship is a mutual decision, but usually, one person chooses to end it.

▽ Breakup reasons

While the breakup details are unique to each relationship, there are some common causes for relationships coming to an end.



△ The people in the relationship may not be connecting in some way, emotionally or physically.



△ If one person in the couple moves away, it can be hard to make a long-distance relationship work.



△ One person may meet someone else who they're more interested in, or may "cheat" on their partner.



△ Neither person in the couple takes the relationship or their partner seriously.

Breaking up with someone

Kindness and honesty are important in a relationship—and this is true when ending a relationship, too. If one person in a couple has lost interest in the other, then explaining this is the kindest thing to do. Breaking up face-to-face, in person, is best, or by video or audio chat if distance or lack of transportation makes that impossible.

Feigning interest is dishonest and unfair to everyone involved, and will only lead to more pain further down the line. It's also kinder to tell someone that the relationship is over rather than hoping that they get the message by avoiding them or talking to them less and less.



△ Splitting up

Walking away from a relationship can be difficult for both people in a couple.

ALERT!

Safety concerns

If you're worried about being harmed, emotionally or physically, then you need to consider your safety over being kind to the other person. Call on your friends and family as a support system, so that you know you will be safe. Ending an unhealthy or abusive relationship by text message is the best choice instead of in person. It's also a good idea to block the person online—not out of meanness, but so that you can recover and move on.